EXECUTIVE BRIEF

# Canadian Crime, 2025

*Overall crime eased in 2025 — but only modestly after increasing for a decade, with some crimes still up*

Prepared with AI assistance and reviewed · August 2026

T L ; D R

# 2025 vs 2024: headline crime rates and severity down

**−4.86%**

**Crime Severity Index**

*Second straight annual decline.*

**−2.4%**

**Overall crime rate**

*Per 100,000 population, vs. 2024.*

**+2.35%**

**Weighted clearance rate**

*Police solved cases at a higher rate, weighted for severity*

**−16.5%**

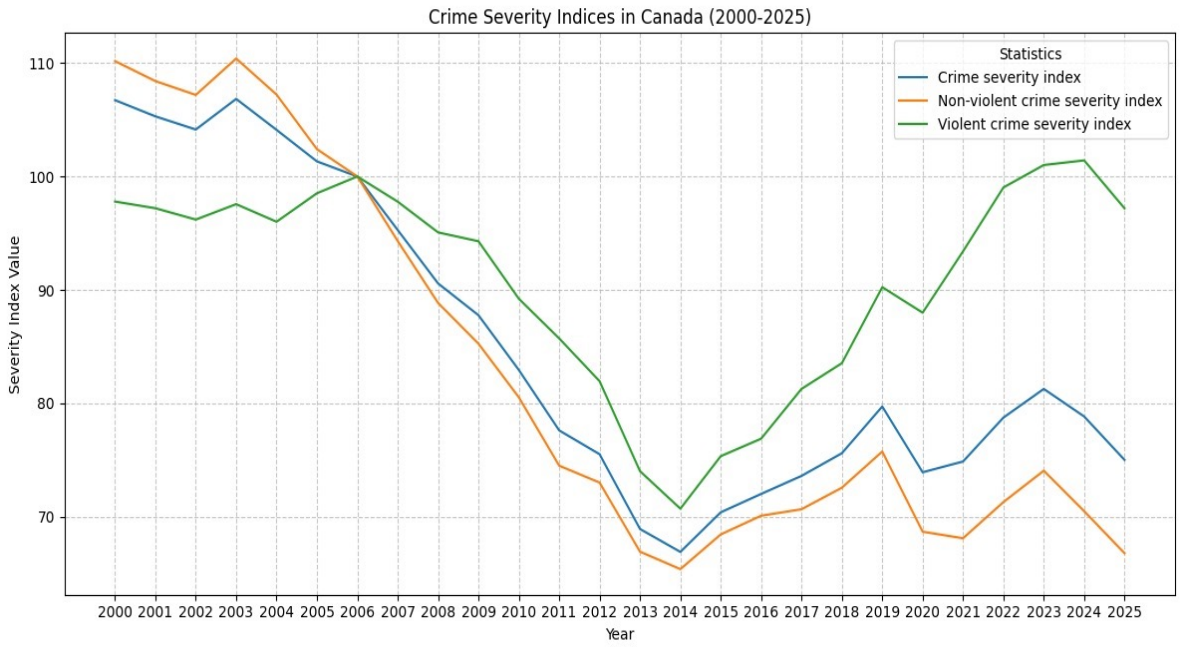
**Homicide rate**

*First-degree murder down 23.7%.*

*Overall crime rate and severity went down and police case clearance rate moved up*

THE LONG VIEW

# Crime Severity Index down after a long climb




**The 2025 numbers**

CSI 75.01 (−4.86%). Non-violent CSI 66.78 (−5.26%). Violent CSI 97.19 (−4.17%).

**A modest reversal, not a return**

Violent CSI climbed almost every year from 2014 through 2024. 2025's dip walks back only a fraction of that decade-long climb.

**Non-violent led the improvement**

Non-violent CSI drove most of the 2025 improvement — youth non-violent CSI fell −6.41%.

Statistics Canada, 2000–2025

THE GOOD NEWS

# Improvement across most major categories vs. last year

## 01 Violent crime

**–16.5%** Homicide rate

**–23.7%** First-degree murder rate

**–15.0%** Attempted murder rate

*Deep declines in some of the most serious offences.*

## 02 Property crime

**–16.4%** Motor-vehicle theft rate

**–10.5%** Breaking & entering rate

**–3.8%** Total property crime rate

*Big-ticket property crimes fell sharply.*

## 03 Cyber, organized & hate

**2nd yr** Cybercrime — second year of decline

**1st yr** Organized crime — first drop since 2021

**–3%** Hate crime incidents

*All three categories saw declines in 2025 vs. 2024.*

Year-over-year change vs. 2024 · rates per 100,000 population

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

BUT NOT EVERYWHERE

# Serious offences that still moved the wrong way

**+4.10%** — **Arson, disregard for human life**

**+3.49%** — **Sexual assault, level 2 (weapon or bodily harm)**
Sexual assault categories moved unevenly — level 1 was −1.22%, level 3 was −3.19%, but level 2 climbed.

**+16.7%** — **Trafficking in stolen property**
A sharp jump, even as motor-vehicle theft and B&E fell sharply.

**+11.4%** — **Shoplifting $5,000 or under**
Continues to run against the broader property-crime decline.

**+2.66%** — **Theft over $5,000**
One of the few high-value property categories to rise year over year.

Percentage change in rate per 100,000 population, 2025 vs. 2024

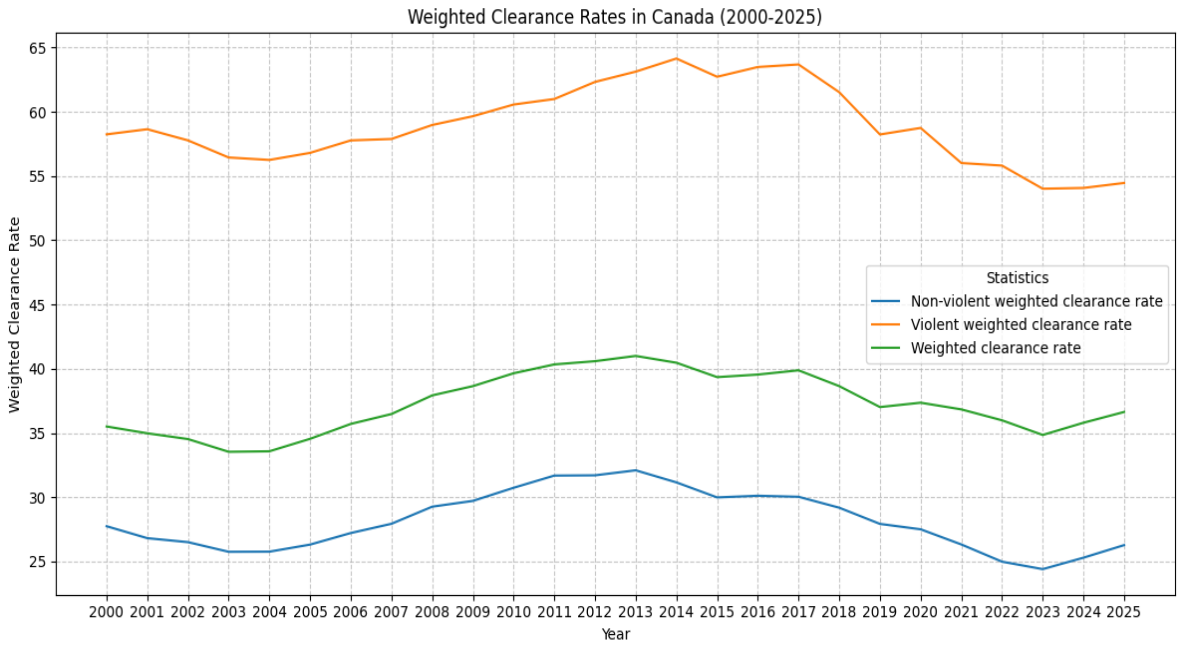
WHY THIS MATTERS

The overall picture is down, but **the headline masks pockets that got worse** — and two of them (arson-with-disregard-for-life and level-2 sexual assault) sit at the serious end of the harm scale.

*Year-over-year percentage change in rate, 2025 vs. 2024.*

POLICE CLEARANCE

# Clearance rate ticks up for the second year, after decline




**The 2025 numbers**

Overall weighted clearance rate 36.64% (+2.35%). Violent 54.46%. Non-violent 26.28%.

**A reversal, but off a decade-long slide**

Clearance rates had trended down for years, especially for violent crime. 2025 is a second uptick.

**A start, not a fix**

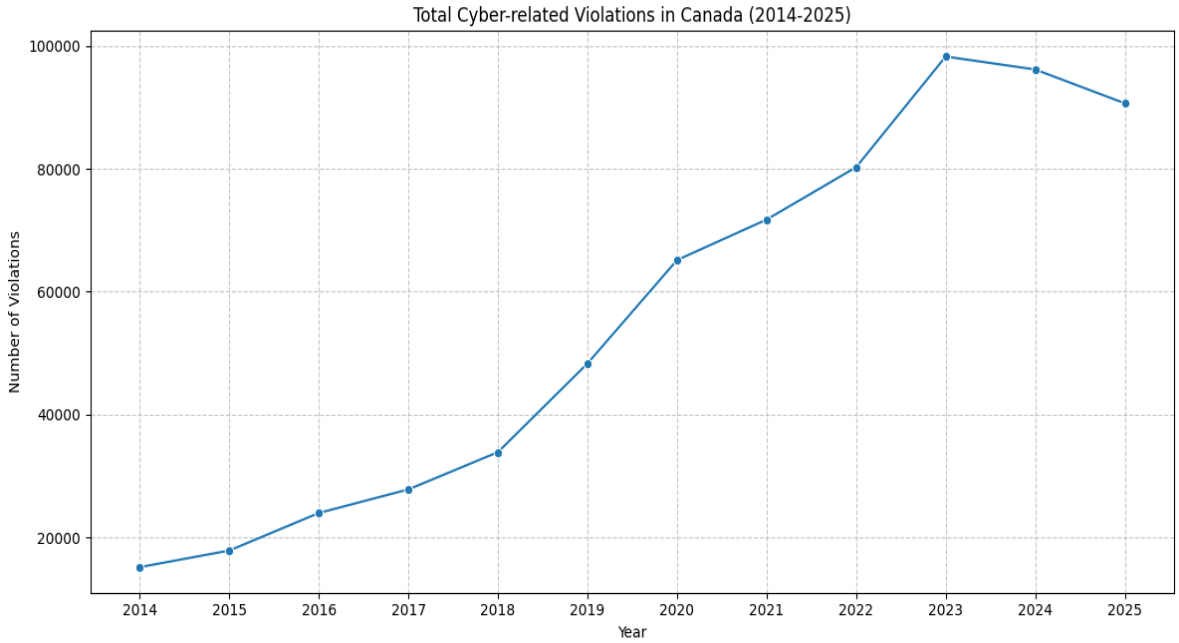
Non-violent weighted clearance rate at ~26%, but still better than 2024

Weighted clearance rate, Canada · StatCan Table 35-10-0026

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

ONE TO WATCH

# Cybercrime plateaus — a second straight year off the ~~pe~~ak




**The 2025 number**

90,643 cyber-related violations in 2025 — a second straight annual decline from the peak reached in 2023.

**But look at the scale**

Still ~6× the 2014 baseline. The plateau is high, not low.

**Fraud dominates**

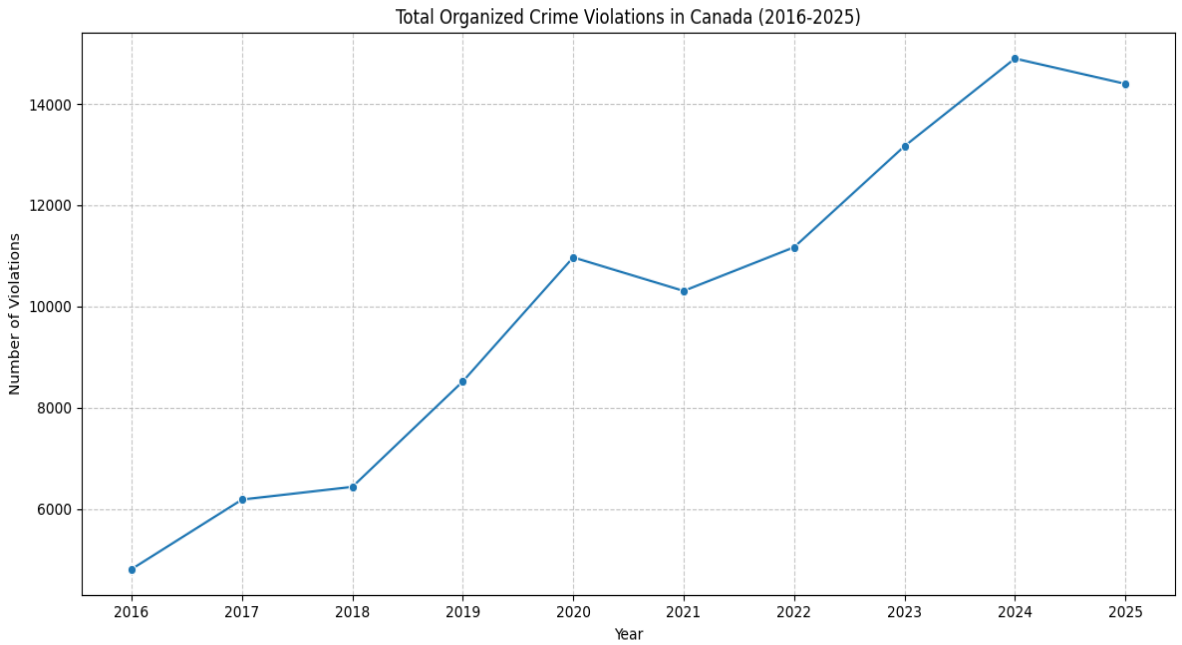
Fraud alone accounts for 44,542 of 2025 cyber violations — nearly half the total.

Canada, selected police services · StatCan Table 35-10-0001

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

ONE TO WATCH

# Organized crime — 2025 breaks a 5-year climb




**The 2025 number**

14,398 organized-crime violations in 2025 — the first year-over-year decline since 2021.

**Still near the peak**

Roughly tripled from 4,810 violations in 2016, so 2025 remains nearly 3× the 2016 level.

**Where the volume is**

Fraud (6,728) and motor-vehicle theft (1,475) remain the top two organized-crime charges in 2025.

Canada, selected police services

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release